



THE GREATEST SALESMAN IN THE WORLD

OG MANDINO



The Big “So What”

Through a fable about a poor camel boy who rose to success, this book lays out timeless principles for salesmanship and personal success that can be learned and applied by anyone.



Introduction

The story in the book centers around Hafid, a poor camel boy who became the owner of the most powerful trade empire of his time and was known as the greatest salesman in the world. The first half of the book is about how Hafid learned the art of salesmanship from a set of ancient scrolls, while the second half of the book presents the text from each of the 10 scrolls.

The scrolls cover broad success principles that have withstood the test of time. In this summary, we'll outline the story in the book, followed by the key ideas from each of the 10 scrolls.



The Story



Hafid was a camel boy working for Pathros, a successful trader in Jerusalem. He had fallen for Calneh, the daughter of a rich merchant and wanted to rise above his low-born station to win her hand.

- Hafid often heard Pathros saying that the best way to move from poverty to wealth was to become a salesman. So, he asked for Pathros' permission to sell his goods.
- Pathros agreed to assist Hafid, but advised him that material wealth should never be the end goal—real wealth lies in the heart, in happiness, love and peace. He also cautioned Hafid

KEY QUOTES

“No other trade or profession has more opportunity for one to rise from poverty to great wealth than that of a salesman.”

“Do not aspire for wealth and labor not only to be rich. Strive instead for happiness, to be loved and to love, and most important, to acquire peace of mind and serenity.”

that becoming a great salesman would not be easy. Hafid would have to endure countless setbacks and the loneliness of traveling far from his loved ones.



Hafid's first task was to find a way to sell a fine, red robe in the poor village of Bethlehem.

- Before he left, Pathros left him with a parting advice: *If your will to succeed is strong enough, you will never fail.*
- After 3 days, Hafid still hadn't sold the robe and was starting to feel discouraged. However, he recalled Pathros' advice and his love for Calneh, and renewed his resolve to keep trying.
- Hafid returned to his cave to find that a couple had sought refuge there with a new-born baby. Seeing how thinly-clothed they were in the cold weather, he gave them the robe to keep them warm.



After he returned to Pathros' caravan, Hafid shared what had happened. He was surprised when Pathros did not reproach him, but took out a cedar chest containing 10 numbered scrolls.



Pathros shared that he, too, started out as a poor boy. He was given the chest of scrolls by a man he saved, and became successful only after he memorized and practised each of the scrolls until the words became a part of him and his daily habits.



He passed the chest and its scrolls to Hafid, with 3 conditions:

- To always follow the instructions in Scroll I;
- To share 50% of all earnings with the less fortunate; and
- Never to share the scrolls or their contents with others unless he received a clear sign that the person was the right successor for the scrolls.

Pathros himself had decided to pass the scrolls to Hafid after he heard what he did with the robe, and when he saw a bright star following Hafid back to the caravan that night.

KEY QUOTES

"True wealth is of the heart, not of the purse."

"Failure will never overtake you if your determination to succeed is strong enough."

"To become a master in the art of sales one must learn and practice the secret of each scroll. When one masters these principles one has the power to accumulate all the wealth he desires."

- Realize that success is a state of mind rather than a fixed destination, and all of us have different goals and definitions of success.



Learn to be patient. Success cannot be rushed. An onion plant may grow quickly but also ages quickly within 9 weeks. On the other hand, the king of trees (the olive tree) grows to maturity only in 100 years. Be patient in your quest for success; be like the olive tree, not the onion plant.



Don't worry if you do not have prior sales experience before today. In fact, many supposedly-experienced people are burdened by the wrong ideas, or fail to realize that an action that worked yesterday may no longer work today. The key is to go for principles that will withstand the test of time.



To succeed, the first step is to form good habits. We are slaves to our habits because they control how we act, and thus determine whether we succeed or fail.

- To change your habits, you must replace bad habits with good ones. Each of these scrolls contains a good habit that you can use to drive out the bad ones.
- The first habit to cultivate is to read the scrolls daily:
 - i. Read the words in silence twice daily: when you wake up in the morning and after lunch. Then, read the words again aloud just before you sleep.
 - ii. Start with Scroll I, read it daily in accordance with step (i) for 30 days then do the same for the next scroll until you have completed all 10 scrolls. No matter how simple or familiar the words appear to be, don't gloss over them and never skip even 1 day of reading.
- As you repeat the words daily, they will become firmly imprinted in both your conscious and subconscious minds, and you find yourself feeling more confident, enthusiastic and energized. These positive outcomes will make it increasingly easy to continue your daily actions until a firm habit is formed.

KEY QUOTES

"Experience is comparable to fashion; an action that proved successful today will be unworkable and impractical tomorrow."

"When an act becomes easy through constant repetition it becomes a pleasure to perform and if it is a pleasure to perform it is man's nature to perform it often. When I perform it often it becomes a habit and I become its slave and since it is a good habit this is my will."

Scroll II: "I will greet this day with love in my heart."



Approach everything and everyone with love, as it can be a powerful weapon and shield.



Perspective. Look at everything around you with love. What seems to be "bad" is never truly so. For example, you can't see the stars without darkness and you can't grow without obstacles.



Interactions. When you interact with others, hold back your criticisms and gossips, and amplify your praises and encouragement.

- Love can bring down walls of distrust and hatred—when you extol your enemies, they can become your friends.
- Act as if everyone has great qualities, even if you can't see them. Whenever you meet someone, silently say "I Love You". This will change your mood, your expressions, and your demeanour, which will affect how others respond to you.



Most of all, **love yourself**. It can make you a greater person and protect you from negative events and feelings (e.g. anger and hate).

- Look after your physical body;
- Take care of your mental health by filling your mind with knowledge and wisdom rather than negative thoughts;
- Enrich your soul with meditation and prayer (not pride or complacency); and
- Let go of hatred; enlarge your heart with warmth and love.

KEY QUOTES

"My reasoning they may counter; my speech they may distrust; my apparel they may disapprove; my face they may reject; and even my bargains may cause them suspicion; yet my love will melt all hearts liken to the sun whose rays soften the coldest clay."

"Just as love is my weapon to open the hearts of men, love is also my shield to repulse the arrows of hate and the spears of anger."

Scroll III: "I will persist until I succeed."



No matter what life throws at you, if you keep pushing ahead, you will eventually succeed. If you persist long enough, you will always win. Be like the lion, not the sheep waiting for the slaughterhouse.



Small, repeated actions add up over time to deliver big results. Keep taking 1 additional step at a time until you succeed.

- Realize that the big rewards usually lie at the end of a journey, and you may be just 1 step away from success. Don't stop.
- Remind yourself that by the law of averages, each step that brings failure/rejection also increases the chances of the next step bringing success.



Tomorrow is a brand new day with a fresh start. No matter how bad a day you've had, always end it on a positive note by planting the seeds for success the next day. No matter how successful you've been in the past, never become proud or complacent.

Scroll IV: "I am nature's greatest miracle."



You are unique—there's no other being in this world that looks, thinks and acts exactly like you. Develop your distinct approach as a salesperson, to leverage fully on your unique characteristics, skills and assets.



Human beings only use a fraction of our brain and muscles, and there's always potential to improve. Don't be content with what you've accomplished so far, as you can achieve even more.



Specifically, to multiply your results in sales, you must increase your knowledge of people, yourself and your products/services, as well as refine your communication skills and mannerisms.



Learn to focus your energy fully on the present moment and the task at hand. When you're selling, don't be distracted by your personal problems. When you are at home, don't be distracted by work/sales.

KEY QUOTES

"If I persist, if I continue to try, if I continue to charge forward, I will succeed."

"When others cease their struggle, then mine will begin, and my harvest will be full."

"I am rare, and there is value in all rarity; therefore, I am valuable."

"There is no room in the market place for my family, nor is there room in my home for the market. Each I will divorce from the other and thus will I remain wedded to both."

 Be like Nature: constantly rejuvenate yourself. Treat all failures, problems and pain as opportunities in disguise. With each challenge you overcome, the next one will become easier to handle.

Scroll V: "I will live this day as if it is my last."



The past is over and the future has not arrived. You only have the present moment to act—make the most of every day, as if it is your last.

 Don't waste time or energy on regrets or dwell in past failures. You cannot turn back the clock nor return to the past to change things. At the same time, don't waste time or energy worrying about what could happen in the future as they may not come to pass. Your life is measured by your time on earth. When you waste time, you're essentially wasting your life.

 Be grateful that you're alive today and can still use this time to fulfill your goals or purpose, be it to spend quality time with your loved ones or serve others. Treat each day as if it is your last, use it to the fullest and make each moment count.

Scroll VI: "Today I will be master of my emotions."



Nature moves in cycles, from the tides to the seasons. Likewise, our moods constantly shift between good and bad, high and low.

 Don't let your moods and thoughts control you and your actions. Instead, learn to master your emotions.

- There's always something you can do to manage your feelings, e.g. listen to uplifting music when you're sad, recall past successes when you're discouraged, or remember your failures when you're overconfident.
- Ask yourself: how should you feel in order for your day to be happy and productive? Then, master your emotions accordingly. Your clients are more likely to respond positively to you when you bring enthusiasm and laughter, than when you bring lethargy and gloom.

KEY QUOTES

"This day is all I have and these hours are now my eternity."

"I will waste not a moment mourning yesterday's misfortunes, yesterday's defeats, yesterday's aches of the heart, for why should I throw good after bad?"

"I have but one life and life is naught but a measurement of time. When I waste one I destroy the other."

"Like the tides, my moods will rise; my moods will fall."

"Weak is he who permits his thoughts to control his actions; strong is he who forces his actions to control his thoughts."

"I will master my moods through positive action and when I master my moods I will control my destiny."



Learn to empathize with others, i.e. recognize and understand how other people are feeling, and avoid judging others based on first impressions. Realize that others have their mood shifts too. Someone who's angry or unpleasant today can be a friendly, approachable client tomorrow.

Scroll VII: "I will laugh at the world."



Laughter is truly the best medicine. Laugh often to release stress, improve your health, and feel happier.



Laughter helps to cut things down to size. It makes big problems look smaller, and reminds us that our successes are not as inflated or as important as we think.



Learn to laugh at yourself. Whenever you start to take things too seriously, step back and consider if that incident or concern will still seem as significant 10 years or 100 years later. This will help you to realize how trivial most of your worries are.



Our feelings (heartaches, exhilaration), financial wealth and successes, and even physical assets, are all impermanent. Constantly remind yourself that "This too shall pass". When you're suffering, remind yourself that the pain and heartache will pass. When you're happy, enjoy the moment as you can't store that moment and it too, shall pass.

Scroll VIII: "Today I will multiply my value a hundredfold."



Find creative ways to create immense value. Wheat can be fed to the pigs, made into flour and bread, or planted for future harvests. Each option takes different time and effort, but also produces different results. Low-value items like clay and wool can be used ingeniously to create castles and fine garments that are worth hundreds or thousands of times more.



Set high daily, weekly, monthly, yearly and life goals.

- Push yourself to improve by setting high goals that are 100x of your best performance in the past. Setting such high goals means that you'll face lots of failures, but you'll also end up achieving much more than if you set a lower goal.

KEY QUOTES

"To enjoy success I must have happiness, and laughter will be the maiden who serves me."

"So long as I can laugh never will I be poor."

"Is it not better to aim my spear at the moon and strike only an eagle than to aim my spear at the eagle and strike only a rock?"

- Don't seek to beat others; seek to beat yourself. Never be satisfied with your results; continuously push yourself to do even better tomorrow.

Scroll IX: "I will act now."



Big dreams and goals are useless if they're not backed by real action. Your actions may not bring instant results, but without action there'll definitely be no results.



Your actions will determine the value you create. To multiply your value, multiply your actions.



The best way to overcome your fear is to take action in spite of it. Remind yourself repeatedly "I will act now". When you face rejection, take action to knock on the next door immediately. When you feel like procrastinating, take action now instead. When you face a distraction, take action to move away from it right away.

Scroll X: "Pray to God for Guidance"



Regardless of our religious beliefs, all of us instinctively pray for help when we're desperate.



Don't pray for material things or rewards. Instead, pray for guidance on how to achieve your goals.



Scroll X ends with a salesman's prayer. Use it to seek guidance to develop your abilities and tap on opportunities, to stay courageous in face of challenges and your weaknesses, to stay humble despite success, to have the discipline and persistence to keep trying, to develop good habits, be grateful and fulfill your true potential.



Other Details in the Book to Look out For

Mandino has carefully worded the original text in each of the 10 scrolls to help readers to grasp the meaning behind the principles. According to Mandino, the key to success is to read each of the 10 scrolls in sequence, 3 times a day for 30 days each. To download the scrolls and get more details and resources, please visit www.ogmandino.com.

KEY QUOTES

"To surpass the deeds of others is unimportant; to surpass my own deeds is all."

"Only action determines my value in the market place."

"Action is the food and drink which will nourish my success."